

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250280193

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

IZUOKA; HIROKAZU

ELECTRONIC DEVICE, SYSTEM, AND CONTROL METHOD

Abstract

An electronic device includes a communication unit configured to perform communication via a communication line. At startup, if the communication line's signal level is at a first level, the communication unit requests power at a first voltage from a predetermined power-supplying accessory. If the signal level is at a second level, the unit does not request power at the first voltage. A setting unit is provided to set the communication line's signal level to the second level after the accessory has been requested to supply power at the first voltage. Additionally, a control unit maintains the signal level of the communication line after the electronic device powers off, ensuring that the signal level remains consistent even when the device is turned off.

Inventors: IZUOKA; HIROKAZU (Kanagawa, JP)

Applicant: CANON KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Tokyo, JP)

Family ID: 96055219

Appl. No.: 19/059953

Filed: February 21, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP 2024-031896

Mar. 04, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04N23/65 (20230101); H02J1/08 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04N23/65 (20230101); H02J1/082 (20200101);

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

[0001] The present invention relates to an electronic device, a system, and a control method.

Description of the Related Art

[0002] Conventional power adapters that supply power to imaging devices have been known. These power adapters are designed in a shape that allows them to be mounted in the battery compartment of an imaging device, and by installing the power adapter in the battery compartment in place of a battery, power can be supplied to the imaging device from power sources including household power. Furthermore, by standardizing the shape of the battery compartment across different models, it has become possible to use batteries and power accessories interchangeably between different models.

[0003] With the advent of multi-functionality of imaging devices, the power

[0004] consumption by these imaging devices has been increasing. The increase in power consumption requires power accessories that can supply more power. Meanwhile, it is also effective to make it possible to use power accessories capable of supplying such high power for conventional imaging devices that have the same battery compartment shape but lower power consumption. Therefore, it is desirable that power accessories can supply power that is suitable for the imaging device to which they are attached. For example, it may be sufficient if the power accessory can output the appropriate voltage and current for the imaging device it is connected to.

[0005] The Universal Serial Bus Power Delivery (USB PD) standard that is compatible with the USB Type-C terminal has been known. Imaging devices and various other devices that are compatible with the USB PD standard have become widely available. According to the USB PD standard, power supply devices can supply multiple levels of voltage and current, and the power-receiving device can request a desired voltage level among the multiple levels that can be output by the power supply device. Therefore, it is effective for power accessories for imaging devices to have the function of a power-receiving device that supports the USB PD standard.

[0006] Japanese Patent Application Publication No. 2005-333709 discloses a DC adapter device having the “function of supplying driving power to an electronic device powered by dry cell batteries.” However, the document does not mention anything about supplying different levels of voltage depending on the electronic device.

[0007] By functioning as a power-receiving device compatible with the USB PD standard, the power accessory can receive different levels of voltage from the power supply device. Accordingly, the power accessory is connected to both the power supply device and the imaging device, and as the power accessory requests voltage corresponding to the imaging device from the power supply device, the voltage corresponding to the imaging device can be supplied from the power accessory to the imaging device. Meanwhile, according to the USB PD standard, when the power supply device and the power-receiving device are connected, power negotiation is performed, and after the power-receiving device requests the desired voltage to the power supply device, the power is supplied from the power supply device. When the imaging device is powered through a power accessory compatible with the USB PD standard, the imaging device must wait at startup until the requested voltage is output from the power supply device after the power accessory performs power negotiation with the USB PD-compatible power supply device.

[0008] In this way, a number of proceedings exist until the desired voltage is supplied to the imaging device from the power accessory. The imaging device desirably executes the startup processing after the necessary power is supplied to the imaging device from the power adapter. This can increase necessary startup time for the imaging device.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0009] It is therefore an object of the invention to prevent an increase in startup time for an electronic device capable of requesting voltage for power to be received from an accessory.

[0010] An aspect of the present invention is an electronic device to which a predetermined power-supplying accessory is detachably connected, the electronic device including: a processor; and a memory storing a program which, when executed by the processor, causes the electronic device to function as: a communication unit configured to perform communication with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, wherein the communication unit executes such communication processing that at startup of the electronic device, 1) the predetermined accessory is requested to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) the predetermined accessory is not requested to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level; a setting unit configured to perform setting processing to set the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested by the communication unit to supply the power at the first voltage; and a control unit configured to perform such control that after power off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device is maintained.

[0011] An aspect of the present invention is a method for controlling an electronic device to which a predetermined power-supplying accessory is detachably connected, the method including: communicating with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, the communicating including, at startup of the electronic device, 1) requesting the predetermined accessory to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) refraining from requesting the predetermined accessory to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level; setting the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested to supply the power at the first voltage in the communicating; and controlling, after power-off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device to be maintained.

[0012] Further features of the present invention will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] FIG. 1 is an external view of a digital camera according to a first embodiment of the invention;

[0014] FIG. 2 is a diagram of the configuration of the digital camera according to the first embodiment;

[0015] FIG. 3 is a diagram of the configuration of an AC adapter according to the first embodiment;

[0016] FIG. 4 is a flowchart for illustrating processing conducted at the startup of the digital camera according to the first embodiment;

[0017] FIG. 5 is a flowchart for illustrating processing conducted at the shutdown of the digital camera according to the first embodiment; and

[0018] FIG. 6 is a flowchart for illustrating processing conducted by an AC adapter according to the first embodiment.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0019] Hereinafter, embodiments for carrying out the invention will be described in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

First Embodiment

[0020] In the description of a first embodiment of the invention, power negotiation is related to “digital cameras” and “AC adapters compatible with the USB PD standard.”

[0021] FIG. 1 is an external view of a digital camera **100** as an example of a device (electronic device) to which the embodiment is applicable. An AC adapter **203** is detachably connected to the digital camera **100**. A display unit **28** displays images and various kinds of information. A shutter button **61** serves an operation unit that performs imaging instruction. A mode selection switch **60** serves as an operation unit to switch between modes. A connection cable **111** is used to connect with external devices (such as a personal computer and a printer). A connector **112** is a connector between the connection cable **111** and the digital camera **100**. The operation unit **70** includes operation members (such as various switches, buttons, and a touch panel) that accept various kinds of operation from the user. A controller wheel **73** is a rotatable operation member included in the operation unit **70**. A power switch **72** is a push button used to switch between power on and power off.

[0022] A recording medium **200** may be a memory card or a hard disk. The AC adapter **203** may be a predetermined power accessory that supplies the digital camera **100** with power. The AC adapter **203** includes a USB connector **204**. The USB connector **204** is a USB Type-C connector. The USB connector **204** is connected with a PD power adapter **205** which is a power supply device compatible with the USB Power Delivery (USB PD) standard. The PD power adapter **205** is a power source device connected to a household power source via a plug **206**. When the PD power adapter **205** is connected with a power-receiving device compatible with the USB PD standard via the USB Type-C cable, power is supplied from the PD power adapter **205** according to the USB PD standard. In FIG. 1, the AC adapter **203**, which is a power-receiving device compatible with the USB PD standard, is connected to the PD power adapter **205**, and power is supplied from the PD power adapter **205** to the AC adapter **203** according to the USB PD standard. In this way, power is stably supplied from the PD power adapter **205** to the digital camera **100** via the AC adapter **203**.

[0023] A slot **201** is used to store the recording medium **200** and the AC adapter **203**. The slot **201** has a battery compartment that is not shown, and when the battery **300** is used as the power source for the digital camera **100**, a battery **300** is mounted in the battery compartment. When the AC adapter **203** is used as the power source for the digital camera **100**, the AC adapter **203** is mounted in the battery compartment in place of the battery **300**. The battery **300** and the AC adapter **203** have the same shape. The user can easily mount either the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203** in the battery compartment, and can also easily remove them from the battery compartment. The battery compartment is also provided with terminals for the digital camera **100** to communicate with the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203**, and terminals for receiving power. When the terminals of the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203** are connected to these terminals, power can be supplied from the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203** and communication is enabled. The recording medium **200** stored in the slot **201** can communicate with the digital camera **100**, such that images obtained from the digital camera **100** can be recorded and played back. The lid **202** is the lid for the slot **201**. In FIG. 1, the lid **202** is open, and the recording medium **200** and the AC adapter **203** are partly taken out of the slot **201** and exposed. The USB cable can be pulled out to the outside when the **202** is closed.

[0024] FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an exemplary configuration of the digital camera **100** according to the first embodiment. An imaging lens **103** is a group of lenses that includes a zoom lens and a focus lens. A shutter **101** includes an aperture function. An imaging unit **22** is an image sensing device (image sensor) including a CCD or CMOS element that converts an optical image into an electrical signal. An A/D converter **23** converts an analog signal into a digital signal. The A/D converter **23** is used to convert an analog signal output from the imaging unit **22** into a digital signal. The barrier **102** covers the imaging system (including the imaging lens **103**, the shutter **101**, and the imaging unit **22**) to prevent the imaging system from becoming contaminated or damaged.

[0025] An image processing unit **24** performs image processing (predetermined pixel interpolation, resizing such as reduction, and color conversion processing) on data from the A/D converter **23** or data from a memory control unit **15**. The image processing unit **24** also performs predetermined calculation processing using captured image data. A system control unit **50** performs exposure control and ranging control on the basis of the calculation results obtained by the image processing unit **24**. In this way, TTL (Through-The-Lens) AF (Autofocus) processing, AE (Auto Exposure) processing, and EF (pre-flash emission) processing are performed. The image processing unit **24** also performs predetermined calculation processing using the captured image data. The image processing unit **24** performs TTL AWB (Auto White Balance) processing on the basis of the obtained calculation results.

[0026] The output data from the A/D converter **23** is written to a memory **32** via the image processing unit **24** and the memory control unit **15** or directly via the memory control unit **15**. The memory **32** stores image data obtained by the imaging unit **22** and converted to digital data by the A/D converter **23**. The memory **32** stores image data for display on the display unit **28**. The memory **32** includes sufficient storage capacity to store a predetermined number of still images, a predetermined duration of moving images, and audio.

[0027] The memory **32** also serves as a memory (video memory) for displaying images. The D/A converter **13** converts data for image display stored in the memory **32** into an analog signal and supplies it to the display unit **28**. In this way, the image data for display written to memory **32** is transmitted to the display unit **28** via the D/A converter **13**. The display unit **28** performs a display according to the analog signal from the D/A converter **13** on a display device such as an LCD. The signal is first A/D converted by the A/D converter **23** and then stored to memory **32** as a digital signal. The digital signal is converted to an analog signal by the D/A converter **13**, and the signal after the analog conversion is sequentially transferred to the display unit **28**. The display unit **28** then functions as an electronic viewfinder, displaying a live image (live view (LV) display). Hereafter, the image displayed in live view will be referred to as an LV image.

[0028] The non-volatile memory **56** is a recording medium that can be electrically erased and recorded. For example, an EEPROM is used as the non-volatile memory **56**. The non-volatile memory **56** may store constants and programs for operating the system control unit **50**. The term “program” here refers to a computer program for executing the various flowcharts that will be described later in connection with the first embodiment.

[0029] The system control unit **50** includes at least one processor and/or at least one circuit. The system control unit **50** controls the entire digital camera **100**. The system control unit **50** executes the programs recorded in the non-volatile memory **56** described above to realize the various kinds of processing according to the first embodiment which will be described. A RAM may be used for a system memory **52**. The system memory **52** may store constants, variables, and programs read from the non-volatile memory **56** to be used for the operation of the system control unit **50**. The system control unit **50** also controls for example the memory **32**, the D/A converter **13**, and the display unit **28** to perform display control.

[0030] A system timer **53** is a timing unit that measures the time used for various controls and the time of the built-in clock.

[0031] The mode selection switch **60**, the shutter button **61**, and the operation unit **70** are operation members that input various operation instructions to the system control unit **50**. The mode selection switch **60** is used to switch the operation mode of the system control unit **50** to one of a still image recording mode, a moving image recording mode, and a playback mode. The still image recording mode includes an auto shooting mode, an auto scene determination mode, a manual mode, an aperture priority mode (Av mode), a shutter speed priority mode (Tv mode), and a program AE mode. The still image recording mode also includes various scene modes and custom modes, which correspond to shooting settings for different shooting scenes. Using the mode selection switch **60**, the user can directly switch between these modes. Alternatively, after switching to the list screen of

the shooting modes using the mode selection switch **60**, the user can select any one of the multiple displayed modes and switch the modes using another operation member. Similarly, the moving image shooting mode may also include multiple modes.

[0032] When turned (ON) in the process of operating the shutter button **61** provided on the digital camera **100**, specifically upon a so-called half-press (shooting preparation command), the first shutter switch **62** generates a first shutter switch signal SW1. The first shutter switch signal SW1 causes operation such as AF (Auto Focus), AE (Auto Exposure), AWB (Auto White Balance), and EF (Flash Pre-Emission) to start.

[0033] When turned (ON) upon the completion of the operation of the shutter button **61**, specifically upon a so-called full press (shooting command), the second shutter switch **64** generates a second shutter switch signal SW2. The system control unit **50** starts a series of shooting processing operations (from reading out a signal from the imaging unit **22** to writing image data to the recording medium **200**) in response to the generated second shutter switch signal SW2.

[0034] The operation members of the operation unit **70** serve as various function buttons. The operation members of the operation unit **70** are assigned functions as appropriate for various situations, for example by selecting various function icons displayed on the display unit **28**. Examples of the function buttons include an end button, a back button, a forward button, a jump button, a narrowing button, and an attribute change button. For example, when the menu button is pressed, a menu screen with various settings that can be made is displayed on the display unit **28**. The user can intuitively make various settings using the menu screen displayed on the display unit **28** and four direction buttons (up, down, left, and right) and a SET button.

[0035] The controller wheel **73** is a rotatable operation member included in the operation unit **70**. The controller wheel **73** is used together with the direction buttons for example to indicate selection items. When the controller wheel **73** is rotated, an electrical pulse signal is generated according to the amount of rotation, and the system control unit **50** controls each part of the digital camera **100** in response to the pulse signal. The pulse signal can be used to determine the degree of rotation of the controller wheel **73** and the number of rotations. The controller wheel **73** can be any type of operation member that can detect rotational operation. For example, the controller wheel **73** can be a dial operation member that generates a pulse signal by rotation of the controller wheel **73** itself in response to rotating operation by the user. Alternatively, the operation member can be a touch sensor that detects the rotational movement of the user's finger on the controller wheel **73**, without rotating the controller wheel **73** itself (so-called touch wheel).

[0036] A power source control unit **80** may include a battery detection circuit, a DC-DC converter, and a switch circuit (a circuit that switches the block to be energized).

[0037] The power source control unit **80** detects whether a battery is mounted, the type of battery, and the remaining battery capacity. The power source control unit **80** also controls the DC-DC converter in response to detection results and instructions from the system control unit **50** to supply necessary voltage to various elements including the recording medium **200** for a necessary period of time.

[0038] The power source unit **30** is the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203**. The battery **300** may include a primary battery (such as an alkaline battery and a lithium battery) or a secondary battery (such as a NiCd battery, a NiMH battery, and a Li battery). In the description of the first embodiment, the AC adapter **203** is mounted in the slot **201** to constitute the power source unit **30**. While the power source unit **30** may be included in the digital camera **100**, the first embodiment will be described assuming that it is not included in the digital camera **100**. Therefore, the description of the first embodiment relates to a system that includes the digital camera **100**, the power source unit **30** (AC adapter **203**), and the PD power adapter **205**.

[0039] A recording medium I/F **18** serves as an interface with the recording medium **200** such as a memory card and a hard disk. The recording medium **200** may be a memory card for recording captured images. The recording medium **200** has for example a semiconductor memory, an optical

disk, or a magnetic disk.

[0040] A communication unit **54** is connected either wirelessly or via a wired cable to transmit and receive video and audio signals. The communication unit **54** can also be connected to a wireless LAN (Local Area Network) or the Internet. The communication unit **54** can also communicate with external devices using Bluetooth (registered trademark) or Bluetooth Low Energy. The communication unit **54** can transmit images captured by the imaging unit **22** (including live images) and images recorded on the recording medium **200**. The communication unit **54** can also receive image data and various other types of information from external devices.

[0041] A posture detection unit **55** detects the posture of the digital camera **100** in relation to the direction of gravity. It can be determined, on the basis of the posture detected by the posture detection unit **55**, “whether an image taken with the imaging unit **22** is an image taken with the digital camera **100** held horizontally or vertically.” The system control unit **50** can add the posture information corresponding to the posture detected by the posture detection unit **55** to the image file of the image taken by the imaging unit **22**, or can rotate the image for recording. The posture detection unit **55** may be an acceleration sensor or a gyro sensor. The posture detection unit **55** may also detect the movement of the digital camera **100** (such as pan, tilt, lift, and whether it is stationary) using an acceleration sensor or a gyro sensor.

[0042] FIG. **3** is a block diagram of an exemplary configuration of the AC adapter **203** according to the first embodiment.

[0043] A terminal **250** is an electrical contact with the digital camera **100**. The terminal **250** includes a power terminal and a communication terminal. Connecting the communication terminal and a communication line **263** with each other enables communication between the power source control unit **80** and a control unit **251** by the communication unit **257**.

[0044] A PD controller **252** communicates with the PD power adapter **205** when the PD power adapter **205** is connected to the USB connector **204**. The PD controller **252** is connected with the control unit **251**. The register of the PD controller **252** can be changed by the control unit **251**.

[0045] A switched capacitor **253** is a switched capacitor type DC-DC converter. The switched capacitor **253** converts input voltage to a fraction (one over an integer) and outputs (generates) output voltage. Here, the switched capacitor **253** converts the input voltage to half ($\frac{1}{2}$) for output.

[0046] A capacitor **255** is a high-capacitance capacitor that can secure power to be used for shutdown processing by the digital camera **100**. The capacitor **255** is connected to the output of the switched capacitor **253** and therefore holds the output voltage (voltage output from the AC adapter **203** to the digital camera **100**).

[0047] A discharge circuit **254** discharges the charge of the capacitor **255** under the control of the control unit **251**. The FET **256** is a field-effect transistor. The FET **256** controls the output of the power of the AC adapter **203** under the control of the control unit **251**.

[0048] An input voltage wiring **261** connects input voltage from the PD power adapter **205** connected via the USB connector **204** to the control unit **251**. An output voltage wiring **262** connects the output of the switched capacitor **253** to the control unit **251**.

[0049] The mounting detection unit **258** detects whether the AC adapter **203** is mounted in the slot **201** of the digital camera **100**.

[0050] The USB connection detection unit **259** detects whether the USB connector **204** is connected to the PD power adapter **205**. The output voltage detection unit **260** A/D converts the signal from the output voltage wiring **262** to detect the output voltage. A non-volatile memory **264** holds operation parameters.

[0051] When the USB connector **204** is connected to the PD power adapter **205**, the PD power adapter **205** first supplies 5 V as the input voltage, and various parts of the AC adapter **203** are activated with power supplied from PD adapter **205**. Next, the PD controller **252** conducts USB PD power negotiation with the PD power adapter **205** via the USB connector **204**, and requests the PD power adapter **205** to supply power at 15V/3 A. When power at 15 V is supplied from the PD

power adapter **205**, the input voltage is converted to half of the voltage by the switched capacitor **253**, and 7.5 V, which is half of 15 V, is output as voltage from terminal **250**. In this way, in the initial state immediately after startup of the AC adapter **203**, a voltage of 7.5 V (initial voltage) is output from the terminal **250**. As will be described later, if no command requesting an output voltage of 10 V from the digital camera **100** is transmitted, the AC adapter **203** outputs an output voltage of 7.5 V. The control unit **251** can also control the PD controller **252** to conduct power negotiation to request a supply of power at 20 V/3 A. Also in this case, the input voltage is converted to half by the switched capacitor **253**, and a voltage of 10 V is output to the terminal **250**. The digital camera **100** according to the first embodiment is designed to be operable at a voltage of 10 V. It is also possible that another model of digital camera that can be connected to the AC adapter **203** may be designed to be operable at a voltage of 7.5 V. In the description of the first embodiment, when voltages of 10 V and 7.5 V can be output from the AC adapter **203**, but the output voltages are not limited to these. For example, if the AC adapter **203** can be connected to multiple models of digital camera, the initial voltage can be the lowest voltage requested by these multiple models of digital camera in order to prevent the digital camera **100** from breaking down due to the supply of high-voltage power to the digital camera **100**.

[0052] With reference to the flowchart of FIG. **4**, among the kinds of processing performed by the system control unit **50**, processing carried out upon the startup of the digital camera **100** (electronic device) will be described. The processing in FIG. **4** is performed as the CPU of the system control unit **50** executes a program stored in the non-volatile memory **56**. Hereinafter, the communication between the digital camera **100** and the power source unit **30** is controlled by the communication unit **54** in the digital camera **100**. The term “startup” here includes the processing started when the user operates the power switch **72** to turn on the power while the digital camera **100** is in the power-off state. The term also includes the processing started when the digital camera **100** resumes from the auto power-off state.

[0053] In step **S300**, the system control unit **50** reads the signal level of the communication line that connects the power source unit **30** and the power source control unit **80**. If the communication line is set to I (p.u.), which enables the internal pull-up setting, there is no communication between the system control unit **50** and the control unit **251** in the AC adapter **203**. Therefore, in this case, an H level is read as the signal level of the communication line. If it is determined that the signal level of the communication line is the H level, the process proceeds to step **S301**. If it is determined that the signal level of the communication line is an L level, the process proceeds to step **S302**.

[0054] In step **S301**, the system control unit **50** sets a negotiation execution flag (hereinafter referred to as an “execution flag”) which is a “flag indicating whether the power source unit **30** performs negotiation” to Off. Then, the system control unit **50** holds the execution flag set to Off (execution flag indicating that negotiation is not to be performed) in the RAM of the system memory **52**.

[0055] In step **S302**, the system control unit **50** sets the execution flag to On and then stores the execution flag (execution flag indicating that negotiation is to be performed) in the RAM of the system memory **52**.

[0056] In step **S303**, the system control unit **50** performs such control that communication between the power source control unit **80** and the power source unit **30** is enabled by disabling the pull-up operation of the communication line between the power source control unit **80** and the power source unit **30**. Note that while the pull-up may be either an internal or external pull-up, an internal pull-up is used according to the first embodiment.

[0057] In step **S304**, the system control unit **50** controls the power source control unit **80** to transmit a command that requests information for the determination of the type (battery type) of the power source unit **30** (hereinafter referred to as a “type determination command”) to the power source unit **30** (the power source unit **30** mounted in the slot **201**). The digital camera **100** can be connected to either the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203**. Both the battery **300** and the AC adapter

203 are capable of communicating with the power source control unit **80**. Therefore, the power source control unit **80** can determine the type of battery by communicating with the power source unit **30**.

[0058] When the command is transmitted from the digital camera **100** in step **S304**, the system control unit **50** repeatedly switches the signal level of the communication line between the power source control unit **80** and the power source unit **30** between the L level and the H level. When the transmission of the command is completed, the system control unit **50** returns the present signal level to the signal level before the transmission of the command. Such processing is also performed in steps **S312** and **S313** which will be described later.

[0059] In step **S305**, the system control unit **50** obtains information on the battery type from the power source unit **30**. The system control unit **50** holds the variable Type indicating the battery type in the RAM of the system memory **52**.

[0060] In step **S306**, the system control unit **50** determines whether the power source unit **30** (the power source unit **30** mounted in the slot **201**) is the AC adapter **203** (power supply accessory) or the battery **300**, with reference to the variable Type. If it is determined that the power source unit **30** is the battery **300**, the process proceeds to step **S307**. If it is determined that the power source unit **30** is the AC adapter **203**, the process proceeds to step **S309**.

[0061] In step **S307**, the system control unit **50** attempts to authenticate the battery **300** and determines whether the battery **300** is an authenticated battery. If it is determined that the battery **300** is not an authenticated battery, control is performed for example “to display guidance on the display unit **28** notifying that the battery **300** is not an authenticated battery and to inquire of the user whether to use the battery.”

[0062] In step **S308**, the system control unit **50** executes the power-on processing of the digital camera **100**. Specifically, the system control unit **50** controls the power source control unit **80** to supply power to each block of the digital camera **100**. If the power source unit **30** is the battery **300**, the power-on processing is executed using the power from the battery **300**. This enables the system control unit **50** to operate functions such as taking or playing back images (still images or moving images). The startup processing of the digital camera **100** is completed when processing in step **S308** is finished. Therefore, the time required from the start of the processing of the flowchart to the end of processing in step **S308** is the startup time of the digital camera **100**.

[0063] In step **S309**, the system control unit **50** determines whether the AC adapter **203** is compatible with the USB PD standard on the basis of the variable Type held in step **S305**. If it is determined that the AC adapter **203** is compatible with the USB PD standard, the process proceeds to step **S310**. If it is determined that the AC adapter **203** is not compatible with the USB PD standard, the process proceeds to step **S308**. When the AC adapter is not compatible with the USB PD standard, the output voltage cannot be changed, and for example, a predetermined voltage is supplied from the AC adapter. The predetermined voltage does not have to be 10 V and can be any voltage that allows the digital camera **100** to operate.

[0064] In step **S310**, the system control unit **50** determines the voltage requested by the digital camera **100** (hereinafter referred to as the “requested voltage”) in the process of executing the program for processing shown in FIG. **4** on the basis of the information read out from the non-volatile memory **56**. The requested voltage by the digital camera **100** according to the first embodiment is 10 V. Therefore, it is determined here that the requested voltage is 10 V, and since it is necessary to request the AC adapter **203** to supply an output voltage of 10 V, the process proceeds to step **S311**. Depending on the model of the digital camera, the requested voltage may be 7.5 V. In this case, since the power at the initial voltage of 7.5 V is already supplied from the AC adapter **203**, negotiation is not necessary, and the process proceeds to step **S308**.

[0065] In step **S311**, the system control unit **50** determines the setting of the execution flag held in steps **S301** and **S302**. If it is determined that the execution flag is set to On (the signal level is the L level at startup), the process proceeds to step **S312**. If it is determined that the execution flag is set

to Off (the signal level is the H level at startup), the process proceeds to step S308.

[0066] In step S312, the system control unit 50 requests the AC adapter 203 to supply an output voltage of 10 V by sending a command to the AC adapter 203 that instructs the AC adapter 203 to switch the output voltage from the AC adapter 203 to 10 V (hereinafter referred to as the “10 V command”). In this way, the system control unit 50 transmits the 10 V command if it is determined in step S311 that the execution flag is set to On (the signal level of the communication line at startup of the digital camera 100 is an L level). In this way, the system control unit 50 requests the AC adapter 203 to supply power at 10 V to the digital camera 100. Meanwhile, if it is determined in step S311 that the execution flag is set to Off (the signal level of the communication line at startup of the digital camera 100 is the H level), the system control unit 50 does not transmit the 10 V command. d. In other words, in such a case, the system control unit 50 does not request the AC adapter 203 to supply power at 10 V to the digital camera 100. Therefore, the digital camera 100 is supplied from the AC adapter 203 with the power at the voltage, which has been requested most recently (in the past) of the AC adapter 203 (the power at the voltage most recently supplied from the AC adapter 203 to the digital camera 100).

[0067] In step S313, the system control unit 50 transmits a response command to the AC adapter 203. The response command requests to respond with the output voltage of the power output from the AC adapter 203 to the digital camera 100. The system control unit 50 also obtains the output voltage information from the AC adapter 203.

[0068] In response to the commands sent in steps S312 and S313, the control unit 251 of the AC adapter 203 performs the processing from step S410 onwards in the flowchart shown in FIG. 6, which will be described later.

[0069] In step S314, the system control unit 50 reads out the information on the output voltage from the AC adapter 203 obtained in step S313. The system control unit 50 then determines whether the output voltage is 10 V. If it is determined that the output voltage is 10 V, the process proceeds to step S315. If it is determined that the output voltage is not 10 V, the processing in steps S313 and S314 is repeated until it is determined in step S314 that the output voltage is 10 V.

[0070] In step S315, the system control unit 50 enables the internal pull-up of the communication line between the power source control unit 80 and the AC adapter 203. This sets the signal level of the communication line between the power source control unit 80 and the power source unit 30 to the H level. Thereafter, when it is necessary to communicate with the AC adapter 203, the system control unit 50 disables the internal pull-up in the same way as in step S303 and enables the internal pull-up again in the same way as in step S315 after the communication is complete.

[0071] If the AC adapter 203 is removed from the slot 201, power is no longer supplied to the digital camera 100, so that the communication line between the power source control unit 80 and the power source unit 30 cannot be maintained at the H level, and the signal attains an L level. Therefore, after replacing the battery 300 mounted in the slot 201 with the AC adapter 203, at startup by the first power-on, it is determined in step S301 that the signal level of the communication line is the L level.

[0072] FIG. 5 is a flowchart of the processing excerpted from the program executed at the shutdown of the digital camera 100 by the system control unit 50. The shutdown processing in FIG. 5 includes the processing executed when the user powers off the digital camera 100 by operating the power switch 72. The shutdown processing in FIG. 5 also includes the processing executed when the digital camera 100 transitions to an auto power-off state. If no operation is performed on the digital camera 100 for a certain period, the system control unit 50 transitions the digital camera 100 to the auto power-off state. Furthermore, if any operation is performed on the digital camera 100 in the auto power-off state, the system control unit 50 executes the startup processing shown in FIG. 4.

[0073] In step S350, the system control unit 50 performs power-off processing for the digital camera 100. Specifically, the system control unit 50 controls the power source control unit 80 to

stop the supply of power to each block of the digital camera **100**. As a result, the system control unit **50** disables functions such as capturing or playing back images (still images or moving images).

[0074] In step **S351**, the system control unit **50** controls the power source control unit **80** to communicate with the power source unit **30** in the same way as in step **S304** and obtains battery type information.

[0075] In step **S352**, the system control unit **50** determines whether the power source unit **30** (the power source unit **30** mounted in the slot **201**) is the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203** on the basis of the battery type information. If it is determined that the power source unit **30** is the battery **300**, the process proceeds to step **S353**. If it is determined that the power source unit **30** is the AC adapter **203**, the processing of this flowchart ends. Therefore, if it is determined that the power source unit **30** is the AC adapter **203**, the system control unit **50** controls the signal level of the communication line between the power source control unit **80** and the power source unit **30** to be maintained at the present level even after the digital camera **100** is powered off.

[0076] In step **S353**, the system control unit **50** controls the power source control unit **80** to instruct the power source unit **30** to transition to the sleep state. In this case, the power source unit **30** sets the controller in the battery **300** to transition to a low-power consumption mode, thereby reducing the power consumption of the battery **300**.

[0077] In step **S354**, the system control unit **50** sets the communication line between the power source control unit **80** and the power source unit **30** to output an L level.

[0078] With reference to the flowchart of FIG. **6**, the processing performed by the control unit **251** in the AC adapter **203** will be described. When the USB connector **204** of the AC adapter **203** is connected to the PD power adapter **205**, power is supplied from the PD power adapter **205**. When connected to the PD power adapter **205**, the control unit **251** is activated by the power from the PD power adapter **205**.

[0079] In step **S400**, the control unit **251** controls the PD controller **252** to start communication with the PD power adapter **205** and performs the power negotiation of USBPD. The control unit **251** then requests the PD power adapter **205** to supply power at a voltage of 15 V. The PD controller **252** requests the PD power adapter **205** to supply 15 V, and the PD power adapter **205** outputs a voltage of 15 V.

[0080] In step **S401**, the control unit **251** controls the output voltage detection unit **260** to read the output voltage from the AC adapter **203** to the digital camera **100**. Here, as described above, the input voltage of 15 V from the PD power adapter **205** is converted to half by the switched capacitor **253**, and the output voltage becomes 7.5 V.

[0081] In step **S402**, the control unit **251** determines whether the output voltage obtained in step **S401** is 7.5 V. If it is determined that the output voltage is 7.5 V, the process proceeds to step **S403**. If it is determined that the output voltage is not 7.5 V, the processing of steps **S401** and **S402** is repeated.

[0082] In step **S403**, the control unit **251** sets the FET **256** to ON. This supplies power to the digital camera **100** if the digital camera **100** is connected to the terminal **250**. Then, the system control unit **50** executes the processing shown in the flowchart of FIG. **4** so that the power source control unit **80** of the digital camera **100** can detect the power necessary to start up the digital camera **100** being supplied. As a result, the digital camera **100** is supplied with power at an initial voltage of 7.5 V.

[0083] In step **S404**, the control unit **251** monitors the output of the USB connection detection unit **259** to determine whether the USB connection has been disconnected (i.e., whether the disconnection between the USB connector **204** and the PD power adapter **205** has occurred). If it is determined that the USB connection has been disconnected, the process proceeds to step **S420**. If it is determined that the USB connection is still active, the process proceeds to step **S405**.

[0084] In step **S405**, the control unit **251** determines the signal level of the communication line **263**. If it is determined that the signal level of the communication line **263** is the H level, it is

determined that there is no communication between the digital camera **100** and the AC adapter **203**, and the process returns to step **S404**. Meanwhile, if the signal level of the communication line **263** is the L level, it can be considered that the “communication is ongoing” or “the AC adapter **203** is disconnected from the slot **201**.” Therefore, if it is determined that the signal level of the communication line **263** is the L level, the process proceeds to step **S406** in order to determine which event has occurred.

[0085] In step **S406**, the control unit **251** measures the period of time (duration) during which the signal level of the communication line **263** remains at the L level using a non-attachment detection timer. If the timer is currently in the process of measuring the duration, the process proceeds to step **S407**. If the timer has finished measuring the duration, it is determined that the AC adapter **203** has been removed from the slot **201**, and the process proceeds to step **S418**. According to the first embodiment, the timer measures the period of time during which the signal level of the communication line **263** remains at the L level for a predetermined period of time (e.g., 500 ms), and then terminates the measurement.

[0086] In step **S407**, the control unit **251** determines the signal level of the communication line **263**. If it is determined that the signal level of the communication line **263** is the H level, which indicates that the signal has attained an H level during measurement by the timer, it is determined that communication is ongoing between the digital camera **100** and the AC adapter **203**, and the process proceeds to step **S408**. If it is determined that the signal level of the communication line **263** remains at the L level, the process returns to step **S406**.

[0087] In step **S408**, the control unit **251** receives data (including commands) transmitted from the power source control unit **80** to the AC adapter **203**.

[0088] In step **S409**, the control unit **251** stops the non-attachment detection timer and clears the count value of the duration (sets it to 0).

[0089] In step **S410**, the control unit **251** determines whether the command obtained in step **S408** (hereinafter referred to as the “obtained command”) is a type determination command (a command that requests type determination for the power source unit **30**). If it is determined that the obtained command is a type determination command, then the process proceeds to step **S411**. If it is determined that the obtained command is not a type determination command, then the process proceeds to step **S413**.

[0090] In step **S411**, the control unit **251** reads out the type information from the non-volatile memory **264**. The type information includes information on whether the power source unit **30** is the battery **300** or the AC adapter **203**, whether it is compatible with the USB PD standard, and information determined by the AC adapter **203**.

[0091] In step **S412**, the control unit **251** transmits the type information obtained in step **S411** to the power source control unit **80**.

[0092] In step **S413**, the control unit **251** determines whether the obtained command is a 10 V command (a command that requests the output of a voltage of 10 V). If it is determined that the obtained command is a 10 V command, the process proceeds to step **S414**. If it is determined that the obtained command is not a 10 V command, the process proceeds to step **S415**.

[0093] In step **S414**, the control unit **251** requests the PD power adapter **205** to supply power at 20 V (performs negotiation with the PD power adapter **205**). In this case, the control unit **251** controls the PD controller **252** to communicate with the PD power adapter **205**.

[0094] In step **S415**, the control unit **251** determines whether the obtained command is a command that requests a response for the output voltage (hereinafter referred to as a “response command”). If it is determined that the obtained command is a response command, the process proceeds to step **S416**. If it is determined that the obtained command is not a response command, the process returns to step **S404**.

[0095] In step **S416**, the control unit **251** controls the output voltage detection unit **260** to detect the output voltage.

[0096] In step **S417**, the control unit **251** transmits the output voltage information (information on the output voltage value) obtained in step **S416** to the power source control unit **80**.

[0097] In step **S418**, the control unit **251** communicates with the PD controller **252** to determine the present negotiation voltage. Here, the negotiation voltage is the voltage that the PD controller **252** requests to be supplied from the PD power adapter **205**. If it is determined that the negotiation voltage is 20 V, the process proceeds to step **S419**. If it is determined that the negotiation voltage is not 20 V, the process returns to step **S404**.

[0098] In step **S419**, the control unit **251** controls the PD controller **252** to start communication with the PD power adapter **205** and requests for the supply of power at 15 V (performs negotiation). If the processing in step **S418** is not performed and the timer has finished measuring the duration in step **S406**, the process may proceed to step **S419**.

[0099] In step **S420**, the control unit **251** requests the digital camera **100** to execute the processing of the flowchart of FIG. 5 by transmitting a request to stop the camera function to the power source control unit **80**. As the PD power adapter **205** is disconnected from the USB connector **204**, power from the capacitor **255** is output to the digital camera **100** via the AC adapter **203**. Therefore, before the output from the capacitor **255** decreases and the power supply from the AC adapter **203** stops, the system control unit **50** performs the power-off processing of the digital camera **100**. The system control unit **50** controls the power source control unit **80** to stop supplying power to each block of the digital camera **100**. Thereafter, when the power supply from the AC adapter **203** is stopped, the level of the communication line with the power source unit **30** can no longer be maintained at the H level, dropping to the L level and entering a power-off state.

[0100] According to the first embodiment, at the power-on, if the signal level of the communication line with the AC adapter **203** is the L level, the digital camera **100**, in principle, requests the AC adapter **203** to supply the power at the voltage requested by the digital camera **100** (requested voltage) and determines the supply voltage from the AC adapter **203**. Meanwhile, at the power-on, if the signal level of the communication line with the AC adapter **203** is the H level, the digital camera **100** does not request the supply of the requested voltage. Therefore, the digital camera **100** receives the supply of the power at the most recently requested voltage by the digital camera **100** (before power off) from the AC adapter **203**. The digital camera **100** controls the signal level of the communication line with the AC adapter **203** at power-off to be maintained after the power off.

Therefore, when the power is turned off while the digital camera **100** is supplied with 10 V, which is the voltage requested by the digital camera **100**, from the AC adapter **203**, the signal level of the communication line with the AC adapter **203** is maintained at the H level. In this state, if the digital camera **100** is powered on again, the signal level of the communication line with the AC adapter **203** is maintained at the H level, so that the AC adapter **203** does not perform power negotiation.

[0101] Therefore, the startup time of the digital camera **100** can be shortened. Power negotiation is performed when it is necessary, and therefore the AC adapter **203** can provide the digital camera **100** with appropriate power.

[0102] According to the present invention, it is possible to prevent an increase in startup time of an electronic device capable of requesting voltage for power to be received from an accessory.

[0103] As in the foregoing, the present invention has been described in detail with reference to the preferred embodiments, but the present invention is not limited by these specific embodiments, and various forms that do not deviate from the gist of the invention are also encompassed by the present invention. Some of the above embodiments may be combined as appropriate.

[0104] In the above description, “if A is equal to or greater than B, the process proceeds to step **S1**, and if A is less (lower) than B, the process proceeds to step **S2**” may be interpreted as “if A is greater (higher) than B, the process proceeds to step **S1**, and if A is equal to or less than B, the process proceeds to step **S2**.” Conversely, “if A is greater (higher) than B, the process proceed to step **S1**, and if A is equal to or less than B, the process proceeds to step **S2**” can also be interpreted as “if A is equal to or greater than B, the process proceeds to step **S1**, and if A is less (lower) than

B, the process proceeds to step S2.” Therefore, as long as there is no contradiction, “A or more” can be interpreted as “greater than A (higher, longer, or more)” and “A or less” can be interpreted as “less than A (lower, shorter, or fewer).” Also, “greater than A (higher, longer, or more)” can be interpreted as “A or more,” and “less than A (lower, shorter, or fewer)” can be interpreted as “A or less.”

Other Embodiments

[0105] Embodiment(s) of the present invention can also be realized by a computer of a system or apparatus that reads out and executes computer executable instructions (e.g., one or more programs) recorded on a storage medium (which may also be referred to more fully as a ‘non-transitory computer-readable storage medium’) to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or that includes one or more circuits (e.g., application specific integrated circuit (ASIC)) for performing the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s), and by a method performed by the computer of the system or apparatus by, for example, reading out and executing the computer executable instructions from the storage medium to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s) and/or controlling the one or more circuits to perform the functions of one or more of the above-described embodiment(s). The computer may comprise one or more processors (e.g., central processing unit (CPU), micro processing unit (MPU)) and may include a network of separate computers or separate processors to read out and execute the computer executable instructions. The computer executable instructions may be provided to the computer, for example, from a network or the storage medium. The storage medium may include, for example, one or more of a hard disk, a random-access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a storage of distributed computing systems, an optical disk (such as a compact disc (CD), digital versatile disc (DVD), or Blu-ray Disc (BD) TM), a flash memory device, a memory card, and the like.

[0106] While the present invention has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

[0107] This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-031896, filed on Mar. 4, 2024, which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. An electronic device to which a predetermined power-supplying accessory is detachably connected, the electronic device comprising: a processor; and a memory storing a program which, when executed by the processor, causes the electronic device to function as: a communication unit configured to perform communication with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, wherein the communication unit executes such communication processing that at startup of the electronic device, 1) the predetermined accessory is requested to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) the predetermined accessory is not requested to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level; a setting unit configured to perform setting processing to set the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested by the communication unit to supply the power at the first voltage; and a control unit configured to perform such control that after power off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device is maintained.
2. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the program, when executed by the processor, further causes the electronic device to function as: a power source control unit configured to receive voltage output from the predetermined accessory, wherein the power source control unit 1) receives the first voltage from the predetermined accessory in case where the

predetermined accessory is requested to supply the first voltage, and 2) receives second voltage lower than the first voltage in case where the predetermined accessory is not requested to supply the first voltage.

3. The electronic device according to claim 2, wherein the second voltage is predetermined voltage supplied from the predetermined accessory in case where the predetermined accessory is not requested to supply the first voltage by the communication unit.

4. The electronic device according to claim 2, wherein in case where the predetermined accessory is requested to supply the first voltage by the communication unit, the predetermined accessory performs processing for changing output voltage output from the predetermined accessory from the second voltage to the first voltage.

5. The electronic device according to claim 4, wherein in case where a power supply device is connected to the predetermined accessory, the predetermined accessory receives power from the power supply device according to USB Power Delivery (USB PD) standard, generates output voltage to the electronic device from the input voltage supplied by the power supply device, and outputs the generated output voltage to the electronic device, and the processing for changing is USB PD power negotiation processing.

6. The electronic device according to claim 1, further comprising a slot in which the predetermined accessory and a battery can be mounted, wherein the control unit performs such control that 1) in case where the predetermined accessory is mounted in the slot, after power-off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device is maintained, and 2) in case where the battery is mounted in the slot and the electronic device is powered off, the signal level of the communication line is set to the first level.

7. The electronic device according to claim 1, wherein the first level is an L level, and the second level is an H level.

8. The electronic device according to claim 7, wherein in case where the communication unit receives a request to stop power supply from the predetermined accessory, the control unit controls the setting unit to power off the electronic device before the power supply from the predetermined accessory is stopped, and wherein the signal level of the communication line becomes the first level.

9. A system having an electronic device and a predetermined power-supplying accessory detachably connected to the electronic device, wherein the electronic device performs processing to communicate with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, wherein the electronic device performs first communication processing including, at startup of the electronic device, 1) requesting the predetermined accessory to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) refraining from requesting the predetermined accessory to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level, the electronic device performs setting processing including setting the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested to supply the power at the first voltage by the first communication processing, after power-off of the electronic device, the electronic device executes first control processing including controlling the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device to be maintained, the predetermined accessory performs supply processing including receiving input voltage from a power supply device connected to the predetermined accessory, generating output voltage from the input voltage, and supplying the generated output voltage to the electronic device, the predetermined accessory executes second control processing including controlling the supply processing so that in case where the request by the first communication processing is not performed, an output voltage at a second voltage lower than the first voltage is supplied, and in case where the request by the first communication processing is performed, an output voltage at the first voltage is supplied, and in the second control processing, in case where the signal level of the communication line is maintained at the second

level, the processing for changing the output voltage by the supply processing is not performed.

10. The system according to claim 9, wherein in the supply processing, 1) in case where the request by the first communication processing is not performed, the predetermined accessory device requests the power supply device to supply a third voltage corresponding to the second voltage, and generates the second voltage from the third voltage as the output voltage to the electronic device, and 2) in case where the processing for changing the output voltage to the first voltage is executed, the predetermined accessory requests the power supply device to supply a fourth voltage corresponding to the first voltage, and generates the first voltage from the fourth voltage as the output voltage to the electronic device.

11. The system according to claim 9, wherein the predetermined accessory receives power from the power supply device according to USB Power Delivery standard.

12. A method for controlling an electronic device to which a predetermined power-supplying accessory is detachably connected, the method comprising: communicating with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, the communicating including, at startup of the electronic device, 1) requesting the predetermined accessory to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) refraining from requesting the predetermined accessory to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level; setting the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested to supply the power at the first voltage in the communicating; and controlling, after power-off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device to be maintained.

13. A non-transitory computer-readable medium that stores a program, wherein the program causes a computer to execute a method for controlling an electronic device to which a predetermined power-supplying accessory is detachably connected, the method comprising: communicating with the predetermined accessory via a communication line, the communicating including, at startup of the electronic device, 1) requesting the predetermined accessory to supply power at a first voltage in case where the communication line has a signal level at a first level, and 2) refraining from requesting the predetermined accessory to supply the power at the first voltage in case where the signal level of the communication line is a second level; setting the signal level of the communication line to the second level in case where the predetermined accessory is requested to supply the power at the first voltage in the communicating; and controlling, after power-off of the electronic device, the signal level of the communication line at the power-off of the electronic device to be maintained.
